

JIGNESH MISTRY

H&M and Marks & Spencer for office outfits. For toys, baby products and clothes for her children, FirstCry and BabyHug are her go-to options.

She was also pleasantly surprised recently to find many home décor items on Swiggy's Instamart, promptly ordering fresh flowers, decorative vases and aroma candles from there. She also finds useful the 20-30 per cent discounts Amazon offers from time to time on a variety of items, and avails herself of them for products like diapers, kitchen essentials and personal care items.

DIPTI KADAM SINHA, 39
Marketing professional, Pune

"Since I have two kids, it is very convenient to get things delivered home. I no longer have the patience or the time to stand in queues or travel to buy things," says Dipti. The month-long return policy helps, giving her time to try products. ■

Soon, the e-commerce universe started offering everything under the sun—apparel, beauty products, big appliances, home décor items, toys. In 2009, from just $0.3 billion (Rs 1,392 crore), the Indian e-commerce market grew to $4.5 billion (Rs 28,431 crore) in 2014, as per a Redseer estimate.

Growing smartphone usage and internet penetration only helped the online shopper tribe increase. Voice search, local language options, lighter versions of apps, deals and discounts, a network of warehouses and delivery partnerships, quick commerce along with cash on delivery, easy returns and refunds, all aided the revolution. From $65 billion (Rs 5.4 lakh crore) in 2023, Redseer projects the Indian e-commerce market to touch $200-230 billion (Rs 17.3-19.9 lakh crore) by 2030. You can only imagine its potential, given e-commerce currently has just a 7 per cent share of the $1,000 billion (Rs 86.5 lakh crore) retail market. ■